

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 583

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the St. John Cultural Arts Center at the Promise Land Historic Site.

WHEREAS, it is our privilege to commemorate a wonderful new cultural center, which provides a welcoming space that fosters transformative educational and cultural encounters to all its visitors; and

WHEREAS, the dedication of the St. John Cultural Arts Center at the Promise Land Historic Site took place on September 8, 2024, at which time this restored church building officially opened its doors to serve as a permanent home to a variety of cultural activities, including choral concerts, art exhibitions, and traveling history displays; and

WHEREAS, the St. John Cultural Arts Center is also available for rental throughout the year for celebrations and meetings; and

WHEREAS, the St. John Cultural Arts Center is housed in the historic St. John Methodist Church, which was once home to the St. John Methodist congregation; originally constructed in the 1880s, the building served as a place of worship for members of the Methodist Episcopal congregation in Promise Land and was the remaining building of three churches that once served the community settled by formerly enslaved persons and veterans of the United States Colored Troops of the Union Army; and

WHEREAS, the current structure was built in 1935 to replace the original church building, which was destroyed by fire; in undertaking the planned restoration of the historic building, Promise Land Heritage Association (PLHA) contracted with Leatherwood, Inc., which worked together with the PLHA Restoration Committee and completed the renovation in December 2023; and

WHEREAS, the building's association with John Lewis and The Promise Land Singers not only contributes to the site as a destination but, together with the School Museum and the history of the Promise Land community, also creates an enduring sense of place; and

WHEREAS, it is most appropriate that we specially recognize this welcome addition to the historically significant Tennessee community of Promise Land; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize the St. John Cultural Arts Center at the Promise Land Historic Site and commend the Promise Land Heritage Association on its continuing efforts to share and preserve the rich history of this true Tennessee treasure.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.